> "I don't see myself as a hero because what I'm doing is self-interested: I don't want to live in a world where there's no privacy and therefore no room for intellectual exploration and creativity."[16]
>
> —*Edward Snowden*

data on Americans in the United States than it was collecting on Russians in Russia. His colleagues were troubled by the revelation but did nothing about it. Earlier, while working in Japan, Snowden said he made recommendations for improving security controls after finding serious flaws with information security. But again, he said nothing was done. Vanee Vines, NSA spokeswoman, said in a statement that after a thorough investigation, including interviews with Snowden's supervisors and coworkers, the agency had found no evidence that he had ever reached out to anyone with any concerns.

Damage to National Security?

One of the biggest criticisms against Snowden was that his actions had severely damaged US intelligence operations. However, no one in the Intelligence Community ever presented proof of harm to the nation's security. Politicians and intelligence officials did report that terrorist groups such as al-Qaeda were changing how they communicated due to the NSA leaks. But the

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